

Red dot design awards

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FICCI Design Conclave

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Feature

eco friendly.” Sandip’s award winning design is a disposable mug made of biodegradable paper and bound together by organic glue. It is capable of holding 1.2 litres of water and disintegrates within 20 minutes. This design was a finalist at INDEX this year, the biggest design award in the world that carries a sum of €5,00,000. In addition, Sandip’s mug has also been recognised with the Best Indian concept at the Business World Design Excellence Awards 2004. The Central Railway had invited him to deliver his product on a pilot project on the Kolkata sector. Five years later, Sandip is still hunting for investors to realise this idea. India is not short of ideas or creative ideas at that. The major hurdle is arranging manufacturers and financing to present your idea in the market. We hope Sandip doesn’t have to hunt for too long, as this holds promise for the millions in India who don’t have an easy access to sanitation.

Another creation by Sandip, the ATE Pencil eater was awarded the Red Dot Design award in 2007. Basically a sharpener, Sandip named it ATE because of its resemblance to the numeral 8. Jindal Steel has recognised his design with the Jindal Stainless Innovation Award 2007.

A significant share of Adobe’s development work is carried out of India. Yet, when the products are shipped abroad, it is the final product that is identified. What stands out is the usability and functionality of the product. The fact that a team of Indians did it, doesn’t stand out. According to Ajay Pande, VP Engineering, Adobe India, it is a global market with the user being global. Earlier, and even today with other vendors, products are significantly localised geographically. This limits the usability, something Adobe has identified. Pande adds, “Our products cater to users irrespective of their geographical location.”

Design is holistic

Design does need a holistic approach and so individual factors such as geographies alone cannot result in the ideal design. What was earlier the Indian choice, no longer holds true. Even Indian consumers are now becoming global consumers and their preferences are becoming global. According to Anil Sethi, President, Sony Ericsson India, “The basic premise behind launching the R&D facility in the country was indeed to improve cost efficiencies by designing global products locally. However, as an emerging trend it can be observed that the needs and behaviour of the Indian consumer are becoming tantamount to their global counterparts. Hence, we would like to leverage our local resources to create cutting-edge products for the global market.”



The ATE Pencil eater (left) by Paul Sandip, and Sandip receiving the Red Dot Design award in 2007 (right)



“Our designers are actively involved in the product development process and help us in deliberating on various design aspects to optimise the product cost”

Anil Sethi, President, Sony Ericsson India

According to Sethi, “At Sony Ericsson, product design is not deciphered as a function of good looks, but is well integrated in to each step of product

development – intelligent features, user-friendly applications, innovative materials, and of course, attractive visual appearance. Design is not an isolated process at Sony Ericsson. At the heart of our design strategy lies ‘User Experience’ (UX) and how best can we energise this experience in the hands of the consumer.”

While the keypads in the Gulf would have Arabic keys; those in Russia, Russian, consumer preferences especially when it comes to product behaviour is now averaging and becoming ‘global’. Effectively, the mobile phone will behave exactly the same way to each key pressed. Sethi adds, “Our Sony Ericsson Creative Design Centre has an extensive studio base spread across Sweden, London, the USA, Asia and Japan where industrial designers work alongside human interface designers, colour and material designers and graphic designers. Industrial designers develop the underlying shape of the product, while human interface designers choose graphical themes, icons and wallpaper for the screens. Colour and material designers work with the texture, materials and colours, and packaging and graphical material is created by graphic designers. The number of designers working on each project varies, but they are all part of a team that collaborates to break new ground in design. We at Sony Ericsson believe in making technology more human,

hence the focus on ease-of-use and one touch access user interfaces.” 



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YOUR DESIGN ON CHILDREN’S DAY

On Children’s Day this year, yes November 14th, the Doodle on Google’s homepage will be the creation of an Indian school student. This is part of a joint effort by Google and the National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad. Google India has reached out to around 10,000 schools across India and has publicised this exciting event. In fact, Dennis Hwang, Chief Google Doodler (what a cool job!) has given tips on how to go about Doodling your very own Google Doogole. You can watch this video at <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TOOY0xuQ3TU>. While this year’s submission deadlines have passed by, keep tab on www.google.com/doodle4google for new entry dates.

